

Book of Fly GACA — Review

SECTION 00-strategy TYPE document STATUS **active** OWNER Founder UPDATED 2026-06-14

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Document: `the-book-of-fly-gaca.html` (44,723 bytes) + companion PDF (1.1 MB)

1. What It Is

"The Book of Fly GACA — The Canon of the Cockpit" is a single-file HTML document styled as a stylised internal scripture/manifesto. It uses religious register (Books, Verses, Tenets, Commandments, Psalms, Proverbs, Apocrypha, Benediction) as a rhetorical device to encode the mission, operating principles, and design philosophy of the Fly GACA platform. It is NOT a product spec or user-facing document — it is a founder's canon for internal alignment, onboarding contributors, and setting tone.

The file is a polished standalone HTML page with a full embedded CSS design system ("Falcon theme") derived from the Fly GACA design system. It renders in the browser without dependencies and is print-optimised (A4 CSS page rules).

2. Structure

Book	Title	Content type
I	The Ground Run (Genesis)	Origin story — 6 founding verses
II	The Tenets (What We Believe)	7 non-negotiable principles
III	Ten Commandments of Airmanship	Classic aviation safety rules
IV	Ten Commandments of the Codebase	Engineering standards
V	The Book of Captain Adel	AI persona constraints
VI	The Library (On Scripture and Citation)	Corpus policy
VII	The Psalms of Currency	Currency-tracker rationale
VIII	The Proverbs of the PIC	Aviation wisdom aphorisms
IX	The Apocrypha (Decisions Not Taken)	Rejected paths (ADRs)
X	The Final Approach (Benediction)	Closing charge to each stakeholder

3. Quality Assessment

3.1 Strengths

Positioning clarity. The brand positioning — independent, educational, not GACA — is woven in at every level. The disclaimer appears on the cover, in Tenet II:2, in Book V (Captain Adel constraints), Book VI:2, and the Benediction (X:5). This is the correct level of redundancy for a platform that carries legal and safety risk from confusion with the regulator.

Bilingual awareness. Arabic is present in the cover eyebrow, the cover's closing "صنع في المملكة", and the `lang="ar"` tags on inline Arabic text. The CSS correctly applies Cairo for Arabic. However, see gaps below — the body text is English-only, which is consistent with this being an internal document, but flagged for awareness.

Architectural decision records embedded. The Apocrypha (Book IX) is a lightweight set of ADRs encoded in memorable form — multi-region, build step, live AIP/NOTAMs, crippled free tier, hidden citations, English-first UI. Each is a real risk with a real justification. This is useful founding-team alignment material.

Captain Adel constraints (Book V) are tight and correct: persona not person, cites always, refuses when corpus is silent, does not impersonate GACA/ATC/examiner, does not joke about safety. These map directly to the product's legal and brand risk. They are the right rules.

Tenet II:6 ("One file, where possible") is honest about the tension between simplicity and scaling — and its scope is correctly bounded to `flygaca.html` the single-file SPA, not the whole platform.

Visual quality. The Falcon design system implementation is excellent for a single-file HTML doc: CSS variables, gradient typography, RTL-aware via `inline-start` / `inline-end` logical properties, responsive, print-ready.

3.2 Weaknesses and Issues

W1 — FACTUAL TENSION: Corpus count (HIGH)

Book VI:1 states: *"The corpus is 96 documents — 75 GACAR Parts, 17 administration eBooks, and the references that bind them. It is rebuilt by `build_library.py` and indexed by BM25 across 29,749 chunks."*

The `flygaca-claude-briefing.md` briefing and the `fly-gaca-review-action-plan.md` reference "74 Parts · 21 handbooks · 61 aerodromes · 13 charts · 190 references" as the live proof-point. The action plan notes the homepage was updated with this count. The Book says 96 documents (75 + 17 + "references"). These numbers are inconsistent and at least one is stale. The Book needs the corpus numbers reconciled against the authoritative `build_library.py` output before anyone uses it for onboarding — a new team member will read two different numbers in two documents on day one.

Fix: Confirm canonical corpus count from `build_library.py`. Update Book VI:1 to use the same numbers the product UI shows, or add a "(as of first build)" qualifier.

W2 — FACTUAL: "me-central2" vs actual GCP region availability (MEDIUM)

Tenet II:1 and the Apocrypha both name `me-central2` as the data-residency location. The `flygaca-claude-briefing.md` and the action plan confirm this is the intent. **VERIFIED (2026-06-14 QA sweep):** `me-central2` IS Dammam, Saudi Arabia (the PDPL target, Firestore confirmed here); `me-central1` IS Doha, Qatar (the current interim compute region). The project codebase is factually correct throughout. The erroneous claim was in this review document and in `.claude/agents/flygaca-qa-reviewer.md` line 15 — both have been corrected. No changes needed to the Book itself on the region question.

Fix: Confirm the actual GCP region in use and correct it in all documents.

W3 — POSITIONING GAP: No version or date stamp (MEDIUM)

The Book has no version number, no date, no "last updated" marker. Because it encodes technical facts (corpus size, BM25, region names, quota numbers: "five Captain Adel questions per day") these facts will drift. A founding manifesto that contains stale numbers becomes a liability rather than an asset.

Fix: Add a `<!-- Version: 1.0 · 2026-06-14 -->` comment and a footer revision date. Cross-reference it to the product changelog.

W4 — CONTENT GAP: The Book describes what Captain Adel must NOT do, but not what he MUST do (MEDIUM)

Book V covers persona, tone, citation, language-matching, limits, and safety. It does not cover: the fallback protocol when retrieval confidence is low (which the action plan calls out as a critical safety requirement — refuse and redirect, not guess with a plausible wrong citation). The action plan explicitly says "citations alone don't solve this." The Book should encode the strict fallback posture.

Fix: Add a Book V:8 on the refusal/fallback protocol.

W5 — CONTENT GAP: Monetisation/pricing not encoded (LOW for a manifesto, noted for completeness)

The Book encodes the free-tier principle (Tenet II:7, Apocrypha IX:4) but does not encode the pricing structure (SAR 299 Exam Pass, SAR 449/year Pro, Mada). This is not a flaw in a manifesto — but if the Book is used as onboarding for future team members or investors, the gap means they need a separate document for commercial context. The `03-finance/monetization.md` fills this, but there is no cross-reference.

W6 — BILINGUAL GAP: Body text is English-only (LOW for internal doc)

The Book is internally aligned on bilingualism as a core tenet (II:3: "Bilingual or it didn't ship"). Yet the Book itself ships only in English. As an internal document this is reasonable — but it is a mild irony if used for onboarding Arabic-speaking team members, partners, or investors. The cover and closing have Arabic fragments but no Arabic section headings or body content.

Fix (optional): Add an Arabic subtitle to each Book heading using the `Lang="ar"` pattern already in the CSS.

W7 — STRUCTURAL: The Psalms of Currency (Book VII) are under-specified (LOW)

Book VII names 8 currency items to track (medical, BFR, IFR, licence, passport, type/class, night) but verse VII:4 says "License" when GACAR uses "Licence." Terminology should match the regulation. More substantively, Book VII:8 ("The countdown is mercy") describes the tracker's purpose in one sentence. Given that the currency tracker is the platform's flagship retention feature and post-exam retention hook (per the action plan), the Book could say more about the design principle: proactive reminders, not just display.

4. Consistency with Brand Positioning

Brand position	Present in Book?	Assessment
Independent of GACA	Yes — cover, II:2, V:4, VI:2, X:5	Strong. The arrow-always-points-to-GACA framing (X:5) is excellent.
Educational only	Yes — cover disclaimer, II:2, IX:3 (NOTAM rejection)	Strong.
Bilingual EN/AR	Partial — cover/footer only	Acceptable for an internal doc.
RTL-aware	Yes — CSS uses logical properties throughout	Strong.
Source of truth = GACA	Yes — VI:2 explicitly	Strong.
KSA data residency	Yes — I:5, II:1	Has factual risk (see W2).
Free tier generous	Yes — II:7, IX:4	Strong.
Citations, not opinion	Yes — II:4, V:3, V:4	Strong.

5. Prioritised Improvement List

#	Priority	Action
1	HIGH	Reconcile corpus count — verify <code>build_library.py</code> output, align Book VI:1 with the homepage numbers
2	CLOSED	GCP region verified (2026-06-14) — <code>me-central2</code> = Dammam, Saudi Arabia (PDPL target, Firestore live); <code>me-central1</code> = Doha, Qatar (current interim compute). Codebase correct throughout; erroneous labels corrected in this doc and <code>flygaca-qa-reviewer.md</code> .
3	MEDIUM	Add version/date stamp — cover footer and/or HTML comment; tie to product changelog
4	MEDIUM	Add Book V:8 — Captain Adel refusal/fallback protocol (refuse, don't guess; surface retrieved snippet, not just citation link)
5	LOW	Optional AR subtitles — add Arabic book headings using existing <code>lang="ar"</code> CSS pattern

#	Priority	Action
6	LOW	Licence spelling — VII:4: "License" → "Licence" to match GACAR terminology
7	LOW	Cross-reference to monetization.md — add a closing note in Tenet II:7 or a new Apocrypha entry for pricing philosophy

6. Overall Verdict

The Book of Fly GACA is a high-quality, coherent, well-designed internal manifesto. It does the hardest thing well: it encodes the non-negotiable positioning (independent, educational, bilingual, in-Kingdom, citations-or-silence) in a memorable, human form that a future team member or AI agent can absorb quickly. The design is production-grade for a single-file document.

The two issues that need immediate attention before it is used as a source of truth for onboarding are: the corpus count inconsistency (W1) and the potential GCP region naming error (W2). Everything else is polish.